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Research Proposal

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The Effect of Short-Form and Long-Form Food Vlogging Content on Fast Food Consumption and Impulse Purchasing Behavior among Urban Consumers in Bangladesh

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Title: The Effect of Short-Form and Long-Form Food Vlogging Content on Fast Food Consumption and Impulse Purchasing Behavior among Urban Consumers in Bangladesh

Research Problem

Digital food content has changed the way people discover restaurants, food items, offers, and eating habits. Short videos on platforms such as TikTok, Instagram Reels, and YouTube Shorts tend to give a quick, pleasurable hit, while longer videos build a story around a product and let the creator share a stronger opinion. Several studies suggest that this kind of content can affect what people eat and how much fast food they choose, although no single effect has been consistently found.

A 2023 review covering six experimental studies and 10,988 participants reported an association between social-media use, exposure to food-company videos or ads, and greater fast-food or unhealthy eating [1]. Another study in 2025 in Uruguay found that exposure to fast-food or ultra-processed-food ads on social media was linked to a 31% increase in the odds of consuming those foods among adolescents [2]. Video content can also have a more direct impact on hunger: a study carried out in 2022 on university students in Turkey found that those who had watched food videos were different from people who had not in terms of their eating behavior and body weight, indicating that the videos had affected their desire to eat [3]. Nevertheless, wider research shows contradictory effects. A 2025 scoping review of 53 mukbang studies found that there were both positive and negative effects on appetite and well-being [4]. Additionally, a separate pilot study from 2025 found that watching mukbang for 10 minutes reduced disordered-eating triggers in Australian students, without having any effect on their body image or anxiety levels [5].

Most of this research is empirical, though, and does not separate the effects of short-form and long-form videos. Bangladesh is a useful setting for this study because fast-food consumption there is shaped through a mix of advertising, social pressure, income, and education: one study of eighty fast-food customers in Mymensingh found that education level, family income, student status, advertising, and social pressure all influenced people's consumption [6], but it did not distinguish short-form from long-form vlogging or allow any conclusions about cause and effect. Overall, these studies suggest that the effect of food videos may depend on the content type, the audience, and how the effect is measured. This study attempts to fill that gap by examining how food content changes people's likelihood of choosing or eating fast food soon after they watch it.

Literature Review

Previous research suggests that food marketing on social media can affect food preferences, appetite, and purchasing behavior. However, important gaps remain. The term “social-media exposure” is often used as a catch-all, even though short-form and long-form videos differ a lot in length, narrative, repetition, and how much information they give. Most studies also measure purchase intention instead of actual purchases or consumption and findings from other countries may not apply directly to urban Bangladeshi consumers because of the differences in food norms, income, platform use, and trust in influencers. Social-media food marketing also tends to look like entertainment rather than advertising: in an Australian study, adolescents were shown 1,801 food promotions across 1,000 minutes of viewing, and 60% of participants only recognized the content as food promotion once researchers pointed it out [7].

Qualitative research also shows that the way a product is presented matters. Product placement, sponsorship disclosure, the credibility of the source, and the format of the post can all affect how viewers understand food promotion, many participants enjoyed food videos made by peers or influencers without realizing they were promotional [8]. To capture this in Bangladesh, the study uses the Stimulus-Organism-Response model from consumer psychology: video format is the stimulus; the viewer's internal state, attention, emotional arousal, how authentic and credible the content feels, social pressure, and FOMO are the organism; and craving, impulse buying, and actual consumption are the responses.

Research on short-form advertising suggests that interactive features can increase the practical, enjoyable, and social value of a video, which can then affect purchase intention [9] . One study of 499 social-commerce users found that features of short-form videos were related to flow and word-of-mouth, while trust was the strongest predictor of purchase intention [10] . Research carried out in Indonesia also showed that genuineness and emotional appeal were linked to emotional arousal and engagement, engagement being the one that predicted impulsive purchase intention, although the cross-sectional design could not establish causality [11].

A combined analysis of social-media and influencer marketing reported that short-form videos tended to support instant engagement, while long-form content was associated with better brand recall [12].

Long-form content gives creators more space to explain a product, provide information, and build a relationship with viewers. This may increase credibility, information processing, brand evaluation, and engagement [12]. This suggests that the two formats may affect different parts of the decision-making process. Short-form videos may create a quicker emotional response, while long-form videos may give viewers more information and time to develop trust. The following model will be tested in this study:

Video format → attention/flow and emotional arousal → authenticity, credibility, social norm, FOMO, and brand awareness → craving and impulse-purchase tendency → fast food purchase and consumption.

Purchase intention is kept separate from actual purchase and consumption in this study because many previous studies relied on surveys and measured intention rather than actual behavior [10], [13].

Research Question

Does seeing short-form or long-form food vlogging affect urban consumers in Bangladesh in terms of their immediate desire for fast food, their impulsive buying, and their subsequent consumption of fast food?

Sub-questions:

1. Does the short-form food-vlogging content cause a greater immediate craving than long-form content?

2. Does the length of the video have an effect on spontaneous purchases of fast food?

3. Do emotional arousal, flow, perceived authenticity, influencer credibility, social norm and FOMO play a mediating role in the effect of video format on purchase outcomes?

4. Will the effects differ according to hunger, age, income, gender, previous frequency of eating at fast-food outlets, use of food-delivery apps, and the intensity of social media use?

Proposed Methodology

Research design: Our research design will be a randomized 2 × 2 experiment in which the first factor is the format of the video (either short or long) and the second factor is the type of content (a food vlog or a neutral video). This will result in four groups: one consisting of a short food vlog, one with a long food vlog, one with a short neutral video, and one with a long neutral video. If recruiting enough participants for four groups is not possible, the study will use three groups: short food vlog, long food vlog, and neutral control. The food-vlog versions will use the same creator, restaurant, dish, setting, music, brand exposure, claims, and call to act. The main planned difference will be video length and the amount of information presented. Having a neutral control will also help separate the effect of video length from the general effect of watching a food-related video.

Participants and setting: The study will be concentrating on adults in Bangladesh, with a preference for people who are 18 years of age or over. In order to take part, individuals must reside in a city, make use of at least one video-based social-media platform, and have eaten or ordered fast food at some point in the last three months. Recruitment will take place online using purposive sampling in cities with populations of 100,000 or more, including Dhaka and at least one other city. The sample will aim to include people from different age groups, genders, income levels, and employment backgrounds. The required sample size will be estimated through a priori power analysis based on the expected effect size, significance level, statistical power, number of groups, and planned comparisons. We will recruit additional participants to allow for possible dropouts before the seventh-day follow-up. Participants whose dietary requirements or health conditions could make exposure to the study content unsuitable will be excluded.

Procedure: Once they have given their informed consent, the participants will fill in a brief baseline questionnaire, the questions addressing their age, gender, present level of hunger, how long it has been since they had their last meal, whether they have recently eaten fast food, whether they use delivery apps, how familiar they are with the creator or the brand, any dietary restrictions they may have, and their awareness of food-related health issues. The participants will then be randomly allocated to one of the video conditions. After viewing the video that has been assigned to them, they will state their level of craving, their emotional reaction, their sense of flow, their perception of authenticity, their assessment of credibility, the extent to which it affects them socially, their feeling of FOMO, and whether they recognized it as advertising.

Participants will then complete a choice task, which serves as the behavioral measure. They can choose to receive a fast-food item, a non-food item, or a cash reward or voucher for watching the video. If this task is not logistically feasible or ethically acceptable, a hypothetical food-delivery budget with delayed or hypothetical compensation will be used instead. The study will record whether each choice is impulsive, planned, or semi-planned.

A seven-day follow-up will then collect information about fast-food consumption and delivery-app orders. Participants will report the number of fast-food meals, where they ate, and how much they spent. They may also keep a short daily record of their food purchases or report the relevant orders at the end of the seven days.

Measures and analysis: The main outcomes will be craving caused by advertisement, impulsive decision-making, and behavioral choice. Other measures will include purchase intention, the number of fast-food occasions during follow-up, delivery-app use, spending, perceived informativeness, authenticity, credibility, flow, emotional arousal, social influence, and FOMO. Any cognitive or comprehension measures will be pilot-tested with people from the target population.

Descriptive statistics will first summarize the sample and the main variables. The reliability and factorial validity of the measurement scales will also be checked. Factorial ANOVA or regression will then be used to examine the main effects of video format and content type, as well as their interaction. Mediation analysis will be used to examine whether factors such as flow, emotional arousal, authenticity, credibility, social influence, and FOMO help explain the relationship between the video condition and the outcomes. We will also explore possible differences by age, gender, income, previous fast-food consumption, social-media use, and delivery-platform use.

As the outcomes in question are categorical, logistic regression will be used to estimate the probability of each of the possible options. When analyzing the occasions on which fast food is consumed, generalized linear models suitable for the type of outcome in question will be applied. Before the main analysis is carried out, the primary outcomes, the criteria for inclusion and exclusion, and the analysis plan will all be specified to reduce the risk of selective reporting and statistical errors. The participants will be analyzed according to the group to which they were originally assigned, in accordance with the intention-to-treat principle. Information will also be given about the missing data, dropout, treatment effects, and the balance of the baseline covariates.

Ethical Considerations

Ethical approval will be obtained from an appropriate institutional review board prior to conducting the study. Participants will be informed of the nature of the study, potential hazards related with the use of food cues, and the privacy of their data, right not to participate, and right to withdraw at any time. The study will not involve inappropriate encouragement or pressure to consume more food or spend more money. If the study includes budget for food or delivery expenses, this should be disclosed to the participants, who will be informed of the monetary value and approximate content of food items and given alternative choices. Data will be collected anonymously and stored securely.

Research Topic

This study concentrates on video format rather than on one particular social-media platform. This makes it possible to examine short- and long-form food content as different types of exposure and connect the findings to communication, consumer actions, nutrition, and digital marketing research. It also separates craving, purchase intention, impulse buying, and actual consumption instead of treating them as the same outcome. This is especially useful for Bangladesh, where research on urban food environments in low- and middle-income countries is still mostly descriptive, with very few causal or intervention studies like this one [14].

The study may also show whether short- and long-form videos affect consumers differently. Short videos may have a stronger immediate effect on attention and emotion, while longer videos may give viewers more information and time to develop confidence or remember a brand. At the same

time, the findings should not be interpreted as proof that either format is harmful, because previous research on mukbang and other food videos has reported both positive and negative effects [4], [5].

Limitations

The figures self-reported are susceptible to both recall and social-desirability bias, at the seven-day follow-up. People who have limited access to the internet might be underrepresented in recruitment carried out online. Commercial platforms provide repeated, personalized, algorithmic exposure which cannot be matched by a single exposure. Although the videos are matched, there may still be differences between the short and long formats in terms of narrative immersion and the amount of information. Lastly, the findings from urban Bangladesh should not be simply applied to rural areas, to minors or to other national settings.

Expected Outcome

The study is expected to show whether short- and long-form food-vlogging content affects different parts of the fast-food decision process. Rather than assuming that one format is automatically more persuasive, the study will examine whether short-form videos are more closely related to immediate craving and unplanned purchase decisions, whether long-form videos are more closely related to trust and recall, and whether these responses relate to later fast-food consumption. This will help address the limited evidence comparing the causal effects of short- and long-form food-vlogging content on fast-food consumption and impulse purchasing among urban consumers in Bangladesh.

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